



When I was a kid, I was a dancer. I was always in school plays and skits."

During one play, she was supposed to be pushing another girl on a swing. Instead, she spotted a cameraman.

"I was just posing for the camera! So I've always been like that since childhood. I've always loved the camera. They say, 'The moment the cameraman arrives, she starts posing!'"

There was even a brief possibility that the camera might have taken her away from athletics.

When she was young, Ancy had long hair that fell below her waist. Filmmakers looking for a young girl with long hair heard about her and approached her mother about an audition.

But by then, she had started athletics. Her coach told her she needed to cut her hair if she wanted

to train properly.

"So when they came for the audition, my mother told them they were a week late! I'd already gone into sports."

She occasionally wonders what might have happened had she gone to that audition.

"When I first heard I wasn't going to go for that film audition, I was really unhappy. But now I think I've done okay. I'm still getting in front of a camera. It's just a different way. I'm still travelling around the world and people still want to see me."

Athletics gave her another stage. And as far as she can remember, she has always liked to perform.

"I remember I used to put bangles on my hands and run in sub-district competitions because I liked the sound they made when I ran down the runway. That's the kind of person I am."

Dream night: Ancy won silver with a 6.63m jump at the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou. GETTY IMAGES

She laughs when she remembers how people reacted.

"A lot of people judged me for it. They would ask, 'Why is this young girl wearing so many chains?' But I never bothered. It's my life. I love wearing jewellery and make-up. What is it to you? It makes me feel confident and I think it's cool.

"And it's not as if I don't perform. I know how hard I've worked to get to where I am now."

Away from the spotlight

For someone with such an obvious inclination for the limelight, Ancy admits that she did not enjoy waiting in the wings. Despite her accomplishments — by 2023, she